THE RESTLESS FOUNDER / FREE GUIDE

The Deliberate Home

Five one-page tools for running the people side of your life on purpose, not on default.

Choose the defaults before they choose you.

Your days already run on default settings.

Most of them were never chosen. They were inherited, copied or left over. A deliberate home starts by looking at what is running.

ROUTINES	What does an ordinary Tuesday look like when nothing is planned and nobody is watching?
MONEY	What happens to money by default: where does it go when you do not decide?
PRESSURE	What is the first thing you do when things get tense: go quiet, go loud, go busy?
HARD TALKS	Which conversation does your home quietly avoid, week after week?

1. **Write one honest line** under each heading, as a description, not a verdict.
2. **Mark each one** keep, change or drop. Most are keep. That is fine.
3. **Replace one default** with a chosen one. One, this week. Not five.

1 THE TUESDAY AUDIT

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Here is what an ordinary Tuesday at home looks like, in my words:
(paste it). Do not judge it. List the defaults you can see in my
routines, money, pressure and hard conversations. Then suggest one
small chosen replacement for the one that costs me most, and nothing
more.
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Describe your own days only. Do not paste private details about other people into any AI tool.

A family business needs a handover, not a hope.

The older generation brings capital, wisdom and experience; the younger brings energy and new tools. It only works if how things run is written down.

What is held

Relationships, judgement, the reason the work exists, the stories, the unwritten rules. Usually in one head.

What is passed

A page the next person can read on a Monday morning and know what to do, who decides and why.

The Baton Page: five lines

THE WHY	One sentence on what this work is for. Not the product, the purpose.
THE RHYTHM	What happens daily, weekly and monthly, and who does it.
THE DECISIONS	Who decides what, and what needs a conversation first.
THE GAPS	What lives only in someone's head. Name it so it can move.
THE FIRST LAP	One small task the next person owns end to end, with a person beside them.

2 THE HANDOVER INTERVIEW

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I am going to talk through how this work runs, out loud and messy.
Ask me one question at a time. When I am done, write the Baton Page:
the why, the rhythm, the decisions, the gaps and the first lap, in
plain words a new person could follow.
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Leave account numbers and private records out of the prompt.

Everything visible costs something invisible.

When a child says another family has a boat, two natural reactions teach the wrong lesson. There is a better answer.

Defend

Explaining what you cannot afford. The child learns money is a sore spot in this house.

Mock

Cutting the other family down. The child learns to cut down what other people have, which is envy.

1. **Get curious.** "A boat? That's cool. What would you do with one?"
2. **Let them dream out loud** for a minute. Dreams are free.
3. **Say the one sentence.** "Every family picks different things. Some pick a boat. We pick other things, and here is what we picked."

The trade ledger

VISIBLE	Name one thing you can see: a boat, a holiday, a house, a gadget.
INVISIBLE	Name what it traded against: time, freedom, savings, a different thing.

3 THE TRADE, KINDLY

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Help me explain to a child of (age) that every family makes trade-
offs with money and time. Give me three short, kind sentences and one
question I can ask them back. No envy, no shame, no lecture.
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Friendship first. Then a weekly walk.

Psychologists talk about love moving from passionate to companionate: the steady, deep friendship that can carry a couple after the early rush. Friendship is built, and it can be built on purpose.

The friendship check-in

KNOW	What do I know about their week that nobody else does?
LAUGH	When did we last laugh about nothing at all?
ASK	What is one question I have not asked them in a long while?

The walk and talk

Some couples keep one practice: once a week, they go for a walk with an agenda.

1. **Same slot, every week.** Thirty minutes, phones away, no children's logistics.
2. **Three things** you did this week that made me feel loved. Take turns.
3. **One or two things** that could have gone better, or left me feeling unseen. Listen first, do not defend, say thank you.

4 THE AGENDA CARD

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Write a one-page walk and talk card for two people. Include the three
questions, the ground rules (one speaks, one listens, no defending),
and a closing line of thanks. Warm, plain words.
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A conversation tool, not counselling. If things are hard, a qualified counsellor is a good next step.

A strong partnership is built like a fortress.

Words either build trust or chip away at it. How you speak about your partner when they are not around says a lot about the relationship, and jokes at their expense plant doubt in other people and in your own mind.

Three rules for the wall

PUBLIC	**Never talk down about each other in public.** No passive aggressive jokes, no put downs.
PRIVATE	**Raise it at home, not in front of others.** Name the issue, not the person.
REPAIR	**When it slips, say so within a day.** One sentence: "That was unfair of me."

Write each rule in your own words, together, and put the page where you will both see it. Decide before the pressure arrives.

5 THE ONE-PAGE AGREEMENT

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Here are three rules my partner and I agreed about how we speak about
each other: (paste them). Turn them into a one-page agreement in
plain, warm words, with one sentence on why each matters and one
repair line we can both use.
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A deliberate home is five small choices, made once and kept: your defaults, your handover, your trades, your friendship, your fortress. Pick one page. Do it this week.

General ideas to adapt, not counselling, legal or financial advice. Results depend on you, the people involved and many things outside your control.